

GED Social Studies Practice Test 10

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC10-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires that proposed laws affecting public pensions include a written estimate of long-term costs before lawmakers vote. The estimate must be prepared by a nonpartisan budget office and must explain how the proposal could affect future state spending.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this requirement?

- A) Helping lawmakers consider fiscal effects before making policy
- B) Allowing courts to appoint state legislators
- C) Giving private companies power to veto laws
- D) Removing financial information from public decisions

GED-SOC10-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A county tracks the average cost of a gallon of milk.

Year: 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023

Average cost: \$3.10, \$3.35, \$3.70, \$3.95

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) The average cost increased each year.
- B) The average cost decreased after 2020.
- C) The average cost stayed the same from 2020 to 2023.
- D) The average cost was highest in 2020.

GED-SOC10-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1830s, many workers formed political organizations that called for shorter workdays, broader voting rights, and public education. They argued that economic independence and political equality were connected. Some employers opposed these demands, saying that business owners should control workplace rules.

Which conclusion is best supported by this source?

- A) Early labor activism linked workplace issues with democratic reform.
- B) Workers in the 1830s avoided political activity.
- C) Employers and workers agreed on all workplace rules.
- D) Public education was unrelated to reform movements.

GED-SOC10-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country has a large river that flows from mountains through farmland and then into a major city. Farms upstream use the river for irrigation, while the city uses it for drinking water and industry. During dry years, disagreements increase over how much water each group should receive.

Which geographic issue is most clearly described?

- A) Competing uses of a shared water source
- B) Lack of any human dependence on rivers
- C) Complete separation of farming and urban areas
- D) The absence of settlement near freshwater

GED-SOC10-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state requires campaign advertisements to state who paid for the advertisement. Supporters argue that voters should know which candidates, parties, or organizations are trying to influence them.

Which TWO civic purposes are supported by this requirement?

- A) It helps voters evaluate the source of political messages.
- B) It increases transparency in campaign communication.
- C) It allows only wealthy voters to cast ballots.
- D) It gives courts the power to write campaign speeches.
- E) It prevents citizens from criticizing candidates.

GED-SOC10-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A county election official argues that automatic voter registration at motor vehicle offices can make registration more accurate because information is updated when residents change addresses. The official says eligible citizens may still choose not to register.

Source B:

A state legislator argues that voter registration should require a separate action by the citizen. The legislator says people should clearly choose to register rather than be added during another government transaction.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether voter registration should be automatic during certain government transactions or require a separate action
- B) Whether elections should be replaced by appointments
- C) Whether motor vehicle offices should count ballots
- D) Whether citizens should be prevented from changing addresses

GED-SOC10-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1850s, arguments over whether new western territories would allow slavery became more intense. Some people supported popular sovereignty, meaning settlers in a territory would vote on the issue. Others argued that slavery should be banned from the territories or protected there by federal law.

Which historical conflict is most clearly described?

- A) Sectional conflict over slavery in western territories
- B) Debate over television ownership
- C) Conflict over women's suffrage after 1920
- D) Disagreement over Cold War alliances

GED-SOC10-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A bill becomes a law after it passes both chambers of Congress and is [D1], unless Congress overrides a [D2].

Dropdowns:

- D1) signed by the president | approved by a state court | counted by the census
- D2) presidential veto | jury summons | local ordinance

GED-SOC10-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city's public transit ridership increased from 4,000,000 rides to 4,600,000 rides in one year. What was the percent increase?

Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC10-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A country's eastern region has several universities and technology firms, while its western region depends more on agriculture and mining. Young adults increasingly move east for higher education and professional jobs.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Regional economic differences can influence migration patterns.
- B) People never move for education or employment.
- C) Agriculture and mining always attract more young adults than universities.
- D) Economic geography has no connection to population change.

GED-SOC10-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

Congress passes a law setting national standards for workplace safety in industries that ship products across state lines. Employers must keep records of certain workplace injuries, and federal inspectors may review whether safety rules are being followed.

Which constitutional power most directly supports this law?

- A) Power to regulate interstate commerce
- B) Power to appoint state governors
- C) Power to conduct local school elections
- D) Power to ratify state constitutions

GED-SOC10-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows the number of telephones in one U.S. city.

Year: 1900, 1910, 1920

Telephones: 8,500, 42,000, 118,000

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) Telephone use expanded greatly from 1900 to 1920.
- B) Telephone use decreased every decade.
- C) Telephone use was highest in 1900.
- D) The city had no telephones by 1920.

GED-SOC10-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution gives the governor authority to call a special legislative session when urgent issues arise. The governor may set the topic for the session, but lawmakers must debate and vote before new laws are passed.

Which statement best explains this arrangement?

- A) Executive authority can call lawmakers together, but the legislature still makes laws.
- B) Governors may pass laws without any legislature.
- C) Courts must write all laws during emergencies.
- D) Special sessions eliminate the need for elected lawmakers.

GED-SOC10-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A city offers a reduced bus fare for seniors. Supporters say it helps older residents reach medical appointments and grocery stores. Transit officials say the city must decide whether to cover the lost fare revenue with tax funds or service changes.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Public subsidies can improve access but require funding choices.
- B) Reduced fares never affect transit budgets.
- C) Seniors cannot benefit from transportation policy.
- D) Tax funds cannot be used for public transportation.

GED-SOC10-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A person is charged with a crime, but the trial ends when the jury finds the person not guilty. Prosecutors then try to bring the same charge again based on the same event. A court blocks the second trial.

Which constitutional protection is most directly involved?

- A) Protection against double jeopardy
- B) Power of eminent domain
- C) Right to appoint cabinet officers
- D) Authority to regulate interstate commerce

GED-SOC10-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

During the 1930s, some New Deal programs hired artists, writers, actors, and musicians. Supporters argued that cultural workers needed employment like other workers and that public art could record American life during the Depression.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) New Deal relief efforts included some cultural and artistic work.
- B) The Great Depression affected workers outside factories and farms.
- C) New Deal programs banned all public art.
- D) Artists were not affected by unemployment.
- E) Cultural work had no connection to Depression-era public programs.

GED-SOC10-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region reports the share of household energy sources.

Energy source: Electricity, Natural gas, Wood, Solar

Share of households: 46%, 31%, 15%, 8%

Which energy source is used by the smallest share of households?

- A) Electricity
- B) Natural gas
- C) Wood
- D) Solar

GED-SOC10-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state court rules that a law cannot require newspapers to pay a special tax that does not apply to similar businesses, unless the state can show a valid reason. The court says special burdens on the press may discourage criticism of government.

Which constitutional concern is most directly involved?

- A) Protection of press freedom from targeted government burdens
- B) State power to command the military
- C) The right of cities to sign treaties
- D) Legislative control over private religion

GED-SOC10-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A company reports the following worker output.

Year: 2021, 2022, 2023

Employees: 50, 50, 50

Total units produced: 5,000, 5,750, 6,500

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) Output per employee increased over time.
- B) The number of employees doubled.
- C) Total output decreased each year.
- D) Output stayed the same from 2021 to 2023.

GED-SOC10-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

During the 1950s, the Montgomery bus boycott challenged [D1] and used [D2] as a strategy for change.

Dropdowns:

D1) segregated public transportation | westward land claims | colonial taxation

D2) organized economic protest | overseas imperial rule | railroad subsidies

GED-SOC10-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state senate has 40 members. A tax bill requires a three-fifths vote to pass.

How many senators must vote for the bill?

- A) 20
- B) 22
- C) 24
- D) 30

GED-SOC10-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A city charter requires council members to live in the district they represent. Supporters say this rule helps ensure that council members understand the needs of the neighborhoods they serve.

Which statement best describes the purpose of this residency rule?

- A) To connect representatives to the communities they represent
- B) To let council members represent foreign governments
- C) To allow courts to choose city council members
- D) To eliminate districts from city government

GED-SOC10-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state requires lenders to clearly show the annual percentage rate, total interest cost, and payment schedule before a borrower signs a loan agreement.

Which personal finance goal is most directly supported by this rule?

- A) Helping borrowers understand the cost of credit
- B) Preventing borrowers from reading loan terms
- C) Requiring all loans to have the same interest rate
- D) Eliminating the need to repay borrowed money

GED-SOC10-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1970s and 1980s, some states passed laws requiring bilingual education or additional language support for students who were still learning English. Supporters argued that students could better learn academic content while developing English skills. Critics argued that schools should focus mainly on rapid English immersion.

Which broader issue is shown by this source?

- A) Debate over how public schools should serve students from diverse language backgrounds
- B) Debate over whether public schools should teach any academic subjects
- C) Debate over whether students should vote in presidential elections
- D) Debate over whether states should control foreign policy

GED-SOC10-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Double jeopardy

- B) Residency requirement
- C) Appropriation
- D) Campaign disclosure

Targets:

- T1) Legal authorization for public money to be spent
- T2) Rule requiring a candidate or official to live in a represented area
- T3) Requirement that political messages identify who paid for them

GED-SOC10-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A rural area has many older residents and few nearby medical specialists. A regional hospital begins offering telemedicine visits, allowing patients to speak with specialists by video from a local clinic.

Which geographic challenge is this program mainly addressing?

- A) Limited access to services because of distance
- B) Lack of need for health care in rural areas
- C) Excessive population density in farm communities
- D) Dependence on ocean ports for medical treatment

GED-SOC10-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state constitution says that laws must be published after they are passed and before penalties can be enforced. Citizens may not be punished under a secret law.

Which civic principle is most directly reflected?

- A) Laws must be knowable before they are enforced.
- B) Legislatures may punish people under hidden rules.
- C) Courts must keep all laws private.
- D) Public laws apply only to elected officials.

GED-SOC10-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state law requires public boards to keep minutes recording motions, votes, and final decisions. The law does not require every discussion to be published immediately, but it does require an official record of actions taken.

Which conclusion is best supported by this policy?

- A) Official records help preserve accountability for government decisions.

- B) Public boards are not allowed to make decisions.
- C) Meeting minutes replace the need for laws.
- D) Votes by public officials must always be secret.

GED-SOC10-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city that grows outward into surrounding farmland is experiencing [D1], which can increase demand for [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) urban sprawl | desertification | maritime piracy

D2) roads and utilities | mountain glaciers | foreign embassies

GED-SOC10-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city reports how residents contacted a public information hotline.

Method: Phone, Email, Text, Walk-in

Number of contacts: 2,400, 1,300, 1,900, 400

How many contacts were made in total?

- A) 5,200
- B) 5,600
- C) 6,000
- D) 6,400

GED-SOC10-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state law allows people to observe court proceedings unless a judge closes a hearing for a narrow legal reason, such as protecting a child witness or confidential information. Supporters say open courts help the public trust that justice is administered fairly.

Which civic value is most directly supported by open court proceedings?

- A) Public confidence in the fairness of the legal system
- B) Secret trials for all criminal cases
- C) Military supervision of judges
- D) Private ownership of courtrooms

GED-SOC10-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state reports voter turnout among registered voters by region.

Region: Lakes, Plains, Hills, Metro

Registered voters: 200,000, 150,000, 100,000, 550,000

Ballots cast: 110,000, 90,000, 52,000, 286,000

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) Plains had a turnout rate of 60%.
- B) Hills had the lowest number of registered voters.
- C) Metro had a turnout rate of 80%.
- D) Lakes had fewer ballots cast than Hills.
- E) Plains had more registered voters than Lakes.

GED-SOC10-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A court rules that a public official cannot block a critic from a government-run online comment page solely because the critic disagrees with the official's policy positions. The court says that when government creates a forum for public comment, viewpoint discrimination is limited.

Which conclusion is best supported by the ruling?

- A) Government-managed public forums must be administered in a viewpoint-neutral way.
- B) Public officials may silence all critics online.
- C) Online comments have no connection to civic participation.
- D) Courts cannot review government-run communication spaces.

GED-SOC10-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows enrollment in community colleges in one state.

Year: 1975, 1985, 1995

Enrollment: 45,000, 92,000, 138,000

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) Community college enrollment increased from 1975 to 1995.
- B) Community college enrollment decreased after 1975.

- C) Enrollment was highest in 1975.
- D) Enrollment stayed exactly the same over the period.

GED-SOC10-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires that taxes be used for public purposes rather than for gifts to private individuals with no public benefit. Courts may review whether a spending program has a legitimate public purpose.

Which claim is best supported by the source?

- A) Public funds should be spent for public purposes.
- B) Taxes may be used only for private gifts.
- C) Courts cannot review public spending.
- D) Public purpose is unrelated to taxation.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC10-001 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Helping lawmakers consider fiscal effects before making policy — Explanation: Cost estimates help lawmakers understand long-term budget effects before voting.

GED-SOC10-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The average cost increased each year. — Explanation: Milk prices rose from \$3.10 to \$3.95 across the listed years.

GED-SOC10-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Early labor activism linked workplace issues with democratic reform. — Explanation: Workers connected shorter workdays, voting rights, and public education to broader democratic reform.

GED-SOC10-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Competing uses of a shared water source — Explanation: Farms, a city, and industry all depend on the same river, especially during dry years.

GED-SOC10-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: It helps voters evaluate the source of political messages. | It increases transparency in campaign communication. — Explanation: Identifying who paid for an advertisement helps voters judge political messages.

GED-SOC10-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether voter registration should be automatic during certain government transactions or require a separate action — Explanation: Source A supports automatic registration with an opt-out, while Source B supports a separate deliberate registration step.

GED-SOC10-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Sectional conflict over slavery in western territories — Explanation: The source describes disputes over whether slavery would be allowed in new territories.

GED-SOC10-008 — Correct: D1=signed by the president; D2=presidential veto — Correct Answer: D1=signed by the president; D2=presidential veto — Explanation: Bills usually become law when signed by the president, though Congress can override a veto.

GED-SOC10-009 — Correct: 15 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 15 — Explanation: The increase is 600,000 rides; 600,000 divided by 4,000,000 equals 15%.

GED-SOC10-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Regional economic differences can influence migration patterns. — Explanation: Young adults move toward the region with universities and professional jobs.

GED-SOC10-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Power to regulate interstate commerce — Explanation: Workplace safety in industries shipping products across state lines involves interstate commerce.

GED-SOC10-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Telephone use expanded greatly from 1900 to 1920. — Explanation: The number of telephones rose from 8,500 to 118,000.

GED-SOC10-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Executive authority can call lawmakers together, but the legislature still makes laws. — Explanation: The governor may call a special session, but lawmakers must debate and vote on laws.

GED-SOC10-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public subsidies can improve access but require funding choices. — Explanation: Reduced fares help seniors but require decisions about covering lost revenue.

GED-SOC10-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Protection against double jeopardy — Explanation: Double jeopardy protection prevents the government from trying a person again for the same charge after acquittal.

GED-SOC10-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: New Deal relief efforts included some cultural and artistic work. | The Great Depression affected workers outside factories and farms. — Explanation: The source shows that cultural workers were included in some relief programs.

GED-SOC10-017 — Correct: D — Correct Answer: Solar — Explanation: Solar is used by 8% of households, the smallest share.

GED-SOC10-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Protection of press freedom from targeted government burdens — Explanation: A special tax on newspapers may discourage criticism and burden press freedom.

GED-SOC10-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Output per employee increased over time. — Explanation: The number of employees stayed at 50 while total units produced increased.

GED-SOC10-020 — Correct: D1=segregated public transportation; D2=organized economic protest — Correct Answer: D1=segregated public transportation; D2=organized economic protest — Explanation: The Montgomery bus boycott challenged segregated buses through an organized boycott.

GED-SOC10-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 24 — Explanation: Three-fifths of 40 is 24.

GED-SOC10-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: To connect representatives to the communities they represent — Explanation: Residency rules help ensure officials live in the districts they serve.

GED-SOC10-023 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Helping borrowers understand the cost of credit — Explanation: APR, total interest, and payment schedule help borrowers understand loan costs.

GED-SOC10-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Debate over how public schools should serve students from diverse language backgrounds — Explanation: The source describes disagreement over bilingual education and English immersion.

GED-SOC10-025 — Correct: T1=C; T2=B; T3=D — Correct Answer: T1=Appropriation; T2=Residency requirement; T3=Campaign disclosure — Explanation: Appropriation authorizes spending, residency rules require living in an area, and campaign disclosure identifies who paid for political messages.

GED-SOC10-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Limited access to services because of distance — Explanation: Telemedicine helps rural patients reach specialists despite distance.

GED-SOC10-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Laws must be knowable before they are enforced. — Explanation: Published laws give people notice before penalties apply.

GED-SOC10-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Official records help preserve accountability for government decisions. — Explanation: Minutes record motions, votes, and decisions so actions can be reviewed later.

GED-SOC10-029 — Correct: D1=urban sprawl; D2=roads and utilities — Correct Answer: D1=urban sprawl; D2=roads and utilities — Explanation: Outward city growth is urban sprawl and often increases demand for infrastructure.

GED-SOC10-030 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 6,000 — Explanation: $2,400 + 1,300 + 1,900 + 400 = 6,000$.

GED-SOC10-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public confidence in the fairness of the legal system — Explanation: Open courts allow the public to observe legal proceedings and trust the process.

GED-SOC10-032 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Plains had a turnout rate of 60%. | Hills had the lowest number of registered voters. — Explanation: Plains turnout is $90,000 \div 150,000 = 60\%$, and Hills has the fewest registered voters at 100,000.

GED-SOC10-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Government-managed public forums must be administered in a viewpoint-neutral way. — Explanation: The ruling limits viewpoint discrimination when government opens a public comment forum.

GED-SOC10-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Community college enrollment increased from 1975 to 1995. — Explanation: Enrollment rose from 45,000 to 138,000.

GED-SOC10-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public funds should be spent for public purposes. — Explanation: The source says taxes and spending programs must serve legitimate public purposes.

